

Standard Operating Procedure

Customer / Client Support Request Handling

Document Owner: Lavish Pandey | Version 1.0 | August 2026

1. PURPOSE

This SOP defines a standard, repeatable process for receiving, triaging, resolving, and closing customer/client support requests, ensuring consistent response times, clear ownership at every stage, and a complete record for quality review.

2. SCOPE

Applies to all inbound support requests received via email, phone, or chat, from initial intake through resolution and closure. Excludes sales inquiries and internal IT requests, which are covered under separate procedures.

3. PROCESS STEPS

- Intake:** Log every incoming request in the tracking system immediately upon receipt, capturing requester name, contact details, channel, timestamp, and a brief description of the issue.
- Categorization:** Classify the request by type (e.g., billing, technical, account access, general inquiry) and assign a priority level using the matrix in Section 4.
- Assignment:** Route the request to the appropriate team member or team based on category and current workload; acknowledge receipt to the requester within the SLA window for its priority level.
- Resolution:** Investigate and resolve the issue, documenting all actions taken directly in the request record. If resolution requires input from another team, follow the escalation path in Section 5.
- Verification:** Confirm with the requester that the issue is resolved to their satisfaction before closing the request.
- Closure & Documentation:** Mark the request as closed, record the final resolution summary and time-to-resolve, and file it for quality review and pattern analysis.

4. PRIORITY & RESPONSE TIME MATRIX

Priority	Definition	First Response	Target Resolution
Critical	Service completely unavailable / affects all users	30 minutes	4 hours
High	Major function impaired for one user/account	2 hours	1 business day
Medium	Minor issue with a workaround available	1 business day	3 business days
Low	General inquiry, no functional impact	2 business days	5 business days

5. ESCALATION PATH

If a request cannot be resolved within its target window, or requires specialist input, escalate in this order: (1) Team Lead — for unclear ownership or resourcing conflicts; (2) Subject Matter Expert — for technical issues beyond first-line scope; (3) Department Head — for Critical-priority items unresolved past 4 hours, or any request involving a dissatisfied client threatening churn. Every escalation must be logged in the request record with a timestamp and reason.

6. ROLES & RESPONSIBILITIES

Support Agent: Owns intake, categorization, resolution, and closure for assigned requests.

Team Lead: Monitors queue health, reassigns requests as needed, handles first-level escalations.

Quality Reviewer: Periodically audits closed requests for SLA compliance and documentation completeness.

7. RECORD-KEEPING

Every request must have a complete audit trail — intake details, all actions taken, escalations (if any), and final resolution — retained for a minimum of 12 months to support quality review, trend analysis, and training of new team members.